

FULL STEEL PLATE PROTECTION

MEDIEVAL ARMOUR

The full steel plate armour worn by knights in the late 15th century offered excellent protection. The helmet was curved in order to deflect the impact of blows from blunt weapons, such as maces, while slashing strokes from swords glanced off almost any part of the surface. The armour was so effective that it offered its wearer protection from everything but crossbow bolts. This Gothic-style armour, with its elaborate decorative details, was made in Germany.

► ARMOUR

Full plate armour was designed to offer a good degree of mobility to its wearer – certainly enough to participate in close-quarters combat on foot or horseback. At around 18kg (40lbs), it was also surprisingly light, and offered such good protection against blows from swords and other edged weapons that the use of more effective blunt weapons such as war-hammers grew increasingly widespread.



Poleyn (knee defence)

Greave (plate armour for lower leg)

Leather overshoes

FULL VIEW

◄ BESAGEW

These small, round shields were attached to the buckle on the shoulder to defend the armpit. Although uncommon in the 14th century, they reappeared in later armour.



◄◄ GAUNTLET

This hand-protecting armour had a series of intricately articulated plates to allow movement.

